




DRAGONBANE





TYPICAL NPCS

TYPE	SKILLS	HEROIC ABILITIES	DAMAGE BONUS	HP	WP	GEAR
Guard	Awareness 10 Swords 12	—	STR +D4	12	—	Broadsword, studded leather armor
Cultist	Evade 14 Knives 14	—	AGL +D4	12	—	Dagger
Thief	Evade 12 Knives 12	—	AGL +D4	10	—	Knife
Villager	Brawling 8	—	—	8	—	Wooden club
Hunter	Awareness 12 Bows 13	—	AGL +D4	13	—	Longbow, leather armor
Bandit	Bows 12 Evade 10 Swords 12	—	—	12	—	Short sword, short bow
Adventurer	Awareness 10 Swords 12	—	STR +D4	13	—	Broadsword, studded leather armor
Scholar	Languages 13 Myths & Legends 13 Staves 8	—	—	7	—	A good book
Bandit Chief (Boss)	Awareness 12 Brawling 15 Hammers 15	Berserker Robust × 6 Veteran	STR +D6	30	16	Heavy warhammer, chainmail, open helmet
Knight Champion (Boss)	Brawling 14 Swords 16	Defensive Double Slash Focused × 6 Robust × 6	STR +D6	28	26	Longsword, large shield, plate armor, great helm, combat-trained horse
Archmage (Boss)	Magic School 15 Staves 13	Focused × 6 Master Spellcaster Robust × 4	—	22	30	Staff, grimoire

NPCS AND SKILLS

Non-player characters use skills in the same way as player characters. The GM rolls dice for them, but only for actions that affect a player character directly - for exemple, if the NPC is attacking a player character or attempting to save them. When an NPC performs an action that does not directly affect a player character, the GM can simply decide what happens.

NPC stat blocks don't list all skills - when rolling for an NPC against an unlisted skill, the GM uses a default skill level of 5.

ATTRIBUTES FOR NPCS

In adventures for *Dragonbane*, attribute scores for NPCs are not listed as they are very rarely used. If you at some point would need to roll against an exact attribute score for an NPC, use the guidelines below:

STR & AGL: Use the damage bonus. At +D6, roll against an attribute score of 17. At +D4, roll against 14. At no bonus, roll against 10.

CON: Roll against maximum HP, reduced by 2 for each level of the Robust heroic ability.

WIL: Roll against maximum WP if this is listed, reduced by 2 for each level of the Focused heroic ability. If WP is not listed, roll against 10.

INT & CHA: Roll against 10.

ROLLING A DRAGON

- You impress everyone around you.
- You achieve more than intended.
- The action is performed faster than usual.

MELEE COMBAT

Can only be dodged if the opponent also rolls a dragon. Choose one:

- Roll double the amount of dice for the weapon's damage, before adding any damage bonus and other bonuses.
- You can immediately perform a second attack against another enemy. This additional attack is a free action.
- Armor has no effect against the attack, as it finds a gap or weak spot. This effect can only be chosen if the attack deals piercing damage (optional rule).

RANGED COMBAT

Can only be dodged if the opponent also rolls a dragon. Choose one:

- Your weapon's damage is doubled, excluding the damage bonus and other bonuses. Roll twice as many dice as normal and add them up.
- Armor and natural armor have no effect against the attack, as it hits a gap or weak spot. This effect can only be chosen if the attack deals piercing damage (optional rule).

MEASURING TIME

UNIT OF TIME	DURATION	ENOUGH TIME TO
Round	10 seconds	Perform an action in combat, take a round rest (page 52).
Stretch	15 minutes	Explore a room, take a stretch rest (page 52).
Shift	6 hours	Hike for 15 kilometers, take a shift rest (page 52).

ROLLING A DEMON

The roll cannot be *pushed*.

- You damage yourself, someone else, or an item.
- You make a fool of yourself in front of everyone around you.
- You make a lot of noise.

MELEE COMBAT

D6	EFFECT
1	You drop your weapon at your feet. Picking it up is an action.
2	You expose yourself to the enemy, who gets a free attack (page 43) that cannot be dodged or parried.
3	Your weapon cuts so deep into an object that it gets stuck. Pulling it free requires a STR roll (counts as an action)
4	You accidentally toss your weapon D3+3 meters. To pick it up you must move and then perform an action.
5	You slam your weapon into something hard and damage it. Any use of the weapon gets a bane until it is repaired by an artisan.
6	You hit yourself by mistake. Roll for damage as usual, but without any damage bonus.

RANGED COMBAT

D6	EFFECT
1	You drop your weapon at your feet. Picking it up is an action.
2	You run out of arrows and must get more before you can use the weapon again. Re-roll for sling or throwing weapons.
3	You hit a valuable or important item nearby. The GM decides what it is.
4	You break your weapon. Any use of the weapon gets a bane until it is repaired by an artisan.
5	You accidentally hit a random player character or friendly NPC. Roll for damage as usual, including damage bonus.
6	You hit yourself by mistake. Roll for damage as usual, but without damage bonus.

ACTIONS

- **Dash:** This action doubles your movement rate in the round.
- **Melee Attack:** These can be performed against an enemy within 2 meters (4 meters for long weapons).
- **Ranged Attack:** Attacks with a ranged weapon can be made against targets within the weapon's range.

  SPECIAL MODIFIERS

  Prone Targets: *Makes the roll with a boon and inflict an extra D6 damage.*

  Obscured Targets: *Makes the roll with a bane.*
- **Parry:** Both melee and ranged attacks can be parried, but the latter requires a shield. Parrying is a reaction that takes place outside your turn and replaces your regular action in the round.
- **Dodge:** Dodging melee or ranged attacks is also a reaction.
- **Pick Up Item:** Pick up an item from the ground within 2 meters, or from your Inventory.
- **Equip/Unequip Armor/Helmet:** Suits of armor and helmets protect you from damage, but also restrict your movement.
- **First Aid:** The HEALING skill is used to save the life of someone who has had their HP reduced to zero and is at risk of dying.
- **Rally:** You can PERSUADE another player character at zero HP to rally and keep fighting.
- **Break Down Door:** Doors can take a certain amount of damage before they break down.
- **Pick Lock:** Picking a lock requires a SLEIGHT OF HAND roll. Doing so without lockpicks gives you a bane.
- **Use Item:** Use a potion or some other item within 2 meters.
- **Activate Ability:** Use an innate or heroic ability.
- **Cast Spell:** In most cases, casting a spell counts as an action. This includes magic tricks. Some spells are reactions and do not require an action, while others are more time-consuming. For more on magic, see chapter 5.
- **Helping:** Helping another character gives them a boon to a roll in the same round.
- **Round Rest:** You rest and recover D6 WP. This can only be done once per shift.

SPECIAL ATTACKS

Find Weak Spot: If your weapon is *piercing*, you can try to find a gap in the enemy's armor or natural armor. You get a bane on the attack, but if it hits, the enemy counts as armorless.

Topple: You try to topple an enemy to the ground instead of inflicting damage. This is handled with an opposed roll between your skill level in the weapon you are using and the enemy's EVADE. If your weapon has the *toppling* feature, you get a boon. The attack counts as an action for you, but not for your opponent. It cannot be dodged or parried.

An effective way of using this special attack is to work together with another person – if you topple the opponent, your friend can attack the prone enemy before they can get up.

Disarm: You try to disarm your enemy instead of inflicting damage. This is handled with an opposed roll between your and the enemy's skill level in the weapons you are using. The attack counts as an action for you, but not for your opponent. It cannot be dodged or parried. If the enemy is holding the weapon with both hands, you get a bane. If you succeed, the weapon lands D6 meters away in a direction of your choice. Picking up a weapon from the ground is an action. Disarm does not work on shields or natural weapons.

Grapple: You try to grapple a humanoid enemy instead of inflicting damage. This is handled with an opposed roll between your BRAWLING and the enemy's BRAWLING. The attack counts as an action for you, but not for your opponent. It cannot be dodged or parried.

If your attempt fails, you fall to the ground. If it succeeds, both of you fall to the ground and the enemy is trapped in your grip. As long as you maintain your grip the enemy can neither move nor perform any action that requires body movement, except trying to break free. Doing so is an opposed roll between your BRAWLING and the enemy's BRAWLING. The roll count as a action for the enemy, but not for you.

While maintaining your grip, you are also unable to move or perform any action that requires body movement, except *break* – this counts as an unarmed attack with a boon that cannot be dodged or parried. Releasing the enemy is a free action.

FREE ACTIONS

- **Draw Weapon:** Draw, exchange, or put away a weapon kept at hand.
- **Change Position:** Throw yourself to the ground or get up.
- **Drop Item:** Drop an item on the ground.
- **Shout:** Say or shout a few words.

SNEAK ATTACK

Sneak Attack: When you sneak up on someone undetected and perform an attack, it is called a *sneak attack*. First you make a SNEAKING roll. Moving close enough to attack in melee combat (within 2 meters) gives you a bane. If you fail, the enemy notices you – draw initiative.

If you succeed your attack counts as surprising, which means that you can choose any initiative card you want. You also get a boon on the attack, and the target can neither dodge nor parry. Using a Subtle weapon increases the damage by one die (for example 2D8 instead of D8). Sneak attacks are always performed individually, by one attacker against one target.

Ambush: A special kind of sneak attack is an *ambush* – lying in wait for an enemy and attacking as it passes by. In this case, each victim makes an AWARENESS roll to spot the ambush, with a bane if the attackers are well prepared. All those who fail get the bottom cards (counting from #10 and up), randomly drawn.

TERRAIN

Cramped: There is little space or a low ceiling. All melee weapons except piercing weapons (page 73) and Subtle weapons get a bane on all rolls.

Rough: The terrain is difficult to traverse. Whenever you move, you must make an ACROBATICS roll (not an action). Failure means that you fall over and lose the rest of your movement this round.

Dimly Lit: Imposes a bane on all ranged attacks.

SHOVE

If you hit an enemy with a melee attack and your STR damage bonus is equal to or higher than your opponent's damage bonus, you can choose to shove the enemy up to 2 meters in any direction (to an adjacent square, if you are using a grid map) in addition to doing damage. This movement does not count toward the enemy's total movement in the round and does not trigger free attacks from anyone. Monsters cannot shove or be shoved.

FEAR TABLE

D8	EFFECT
1	**Enfeebled.** The fear drains your energy and determination. You lose 2D6 WP (to a minimum of zero) and become Disheartened.
2	**Shaken.** You suffer the Scared condition.
3	**Panting.** The intense fear leaves you out of breath and makes you Exhausted.
4	**Pale.** Your face turns white as a sheet. You and all player characters within 10 meters and in sight of you become Scared.
5	**Scream.** You scream in horror, which causes all player characters who hear the sound to immediately suffer a fear attack as well. Each person only ever needs to make one WIL roll to resist the same fear attack.
6	**Rage.** Your fear turns to anger, and you are forced to attack its source on your next turn – in melee combat if possible. You also become Angry.
7	**Paralyzed.** You are petrified with terror and unable to move. You cannot perform any action or movement on your next turn. Make another WIL roll on each subsequent turn (not an action) to break the paralysis.
8	**Wild Panic.** In a fit of utter panic, you flee the scene as fast as you can. On your next turn you must dash away from the source of your fear. Make another WIL roll on each subsequent turn (not an action) to stop running and act normally again.

DAMAGE TYPES & ARMOR

If the optional rule for damage types (page 45) is used, the following rules apply:

- Leather and studded leather gain a +2 bonus to their armor rating against bludgeoning damage.
- Chainmail gets a +2 bonus to its armor rating against slashing damage.

If the type of damage is not stated, the armor has its normal effect.

SEVERE INJURIES

If you have been reduced to zero HP but survived, you risk severe injuries that can take a long time to heal and even have permanent effects. Make a roll against CON. If you fail, roll on the table below.

The healing time is halved if you rest and get medical care for at least a shift per day from a person who makes a HEALING roll. Skill levels that are reduced by permanent injuries can be re-learned.

D20	INJURY	EFFECT
1–2	Broken nose	You get a bane on all AWARENESS rolls. Healing time: D6 days.
3–4	Scarred face	Bane on all PERFORMANCE and PERSUASION rolls. Healing time: 2D6 days.
5–6	Teeth knocked out	Your PERFORMANCE and PERSUASION skills levels are permanently reduced by 2 (to a minimum of 3).
7–8	Broken ribs	Bane on all skills based on STR or AGL. Healing time: D6 days.
9–10	Concussion	Bane on all skills based on INT. Healing time: D6 days.
11–12	Deep wounds	Bane on all skills based on STR or AGL, and every roll against such skill inflicts D6 points of damage. Healing time: 2D6 days.
13	Broken leg	Your movement rate is halved. Healing time: 3D6 days.
14	Broken arm	You cannot use two-handed weapon, nor dual wield, and get a bane on all other actions normally using both arms, such as climbing. Healing time: 3D6 days.
15	Severed toe	Movement rate permanently reduced by 2 (to a minimum of 4).
16	Severed finger	Your skill levels in all weapon skills are permanently reduced by 1 (to a minimum of 3).
17	Gouged eye	Your skill level in SPOT HIDDEN is permanently reduced by 2 (to a minimum of 3).
18	Nightmares	Roll to resist fear (page 52) each shift you sleep. If you fail, the shift doesn't count as slept. Healing time: 2D6 days.
19	Changed personality	Randomly generate a new weakness (optional rule, page 26).
20	Amnesia	You cannot remember who you or the other player characters are. The effect must be roleplayed. Healing time: D6 days.

HEALING AND RESTING

Lost HP and WP are recovered by resting. There are three kinds of rest – round rest, stretch rest, and shift rest. While resting, you cannot perform any actions that require die rolls or WP.

Round Rest: A quick rest that lasts just a single round. During a round rest you recover only D6 WP, no HP. You can only have a round rest once per shift.

Stretch Rest: A short rest that only lasts for one stretch of time. During a stretch rest you heal D6 HP, or 2D6 HP if someone else is tending to you and succeeds with a HEALING roll. The caregiver cannot rest during the same stretch and can only heal one person during the rest.

During a stretch rest, you also recover D6 Willpower Points and heal a condition of your choice. If something dramatic interrupts your rest, the effects are lost. You can only have a stretch rest once per shift.

Shift Rest: A shift rest lasts one full shift of time and can only take place in a safe location where there are no enemies nearby. During a shift rest you recover all your lost HP and WP and heal all conditions. If a shift rest is interrupted by combat or hard work it has no effect.

Magic: Spells can allow you to heal HP more quickly than usual.

JOURNEYS

Player characters who follow a road or clear path are not at risk of getting lost, but such luxuries are rarely available. When they are out in the wilderness, navigation is more difficult, and all sorts of mishaps can occur.

When traveling through pathless terrain, the player characters must appoint a *pathfinder* who leads the way for the group. This person must make a BUSHCRAFT roll every shift to find their way. If the pathfinder has no map, the roll gets a bane. A spyglass gives a boon.

On a failure, the group suffers a mishap – roll on the table on page 102. You can adjust the mishap to better fit the area.

Rolling a Dragon: A pathfinder who rolls a Dragon finds a shortcut – the distance covered this shift is doubled.

Difficult Terrain: If the terrain is particularly difficult, you can add a bane to the BUSHCRAFT roll.

LEAVING THE ADVENTURE SITE

D6	CONSEQUENCES
1	Enemies at the site follow the player characters and attack at an opportune moment.
2	Enemies at the site get reinforcements. Fallen enemies are replaced twofold.
3	Someone else arrives at the site and clears it of treasure before the player characters return.
4–6	Nothing happens.

MISHAPS

D12	MISHAP
1	**Fog.** The player characters are caught unawares by a thick fog. The distance covered this shift is reduced by half.
2	**Blocking Terrain.** The way ahead is blocked by rocks, fallen trees, thick shrubs, or flooding. Each player character must make an ACROBATICS roll to keep moving forward. Anyone who succeeds can help the others. A player character who fails makes no progress this shift.
3	**Torn Clothes.** The pathfinder leads the group into a thorny thicket, rocky ravine, or swampy marsh. The clothes of a random player character are damaged and now count as rags.
4	**Lost.** The player characters realize that they are walking in circles and do not make any progress on the map this shift. The pathfinder must also make a BUSHCRAFT roll to find the right way again. Others cannot help.
5	**Dropped Item.** A random player character drops or breaks an item of your choice.
6	**Mosquito Swarm.** A large swarm of mosquitoes or gnats attacks the group, driving everyone crazy with their biting and buzzing. All player characters without a cloak become Angry.
7	**Sprained Ankle.** A random player character falls or missteps and suffers D6 damage. Armor has no effect but boots reduce the damage by two.
8	**Downpour.** A massive rainfall or blizzard (depending on the season) catches the group unawares. All player characters without a cloak must roll to withstand the cold (page 54). They must also seek shelter until the storm passes and cannot make any progress on the map this shift.
9	**Wasps.** The pathfinder steps right into a nest of wasps. A swarm of angry wasps attacks the entire group. All player characters must make an EVADE roll, and those who fail suffer D6 damage and a condition of their choice.
10	**Landslide.** The player characters are walking in rough terrain when the ground suddenly gives way under their feet. Everyone must make an EVADE roll – anyone who fails suffers D10 damage.
11	**Savage Animal.** A wolf, bear, or other savage animal feels threatened and attacks the adventurers. Choose an animal from the table on page 99.
12	**Quicksand.** The ground collapses! Each player character must make a BUSHCRAFT roll. Anyone who fails suffers a condition and must roll again. A character who already has all conditions and fails the roll is swallowed by the quicksand and disappears for good. Whoever is free can help those who are stuck.